per cent of the municipal waste, which has significantly contributed to its performance as a clean state.

Best Performing Big State: Gujarat

As chief minister, Modi had often spoken about maintaining cleanliness in surroundings—not just one's house, but making cleanliness a part of one's duties as a citizen. As early as 2007-08, the 'Swasth Gam, Swachh Gam' scheme was launched to raise awareness levels at the village level about sanitation and cleanliness. A provision of Rs 600 crore was made under this scheme. In 2016-17, the Mahatma Gandhi Swachhata Mission was launched whereby all gram panchayats were given monetary assistance for door-to-door collection and dumping of the collected waste in the landfill site. By 2016, Gujarat had declared itself 100 per cent ODF (Open defecation free). This claim was, however, disputed by NGOs and independent agencies, including the Comptroller and Auditor General of India in 2018. Ongoing awareness campaigns and administrative efforts have covered much ground, but challenges remain. Clean environment, safe drinking water and sanitation are among the six clearly stated aims under Human Development initiatives stated in the socio-economic review of the state government, released with the state budget in February 2022—97.5 per cent of households have access to improved sources of drinking water and 99.5 per cent of schools have girls' toilets. Women continue to be loyal BJP voters because the government has been hard at work in replacing kerosene and wood burning with clean cooking gas options, particularly in rural households, which have led to better health for women. In 2021, 52.6 per cent of households used clean fuel for cooking, according to the National Family Health Survey of India. If the cities of Gujarat appear clean, there is a reason. According to the ministry of housing and urban affairs, 93 per cent of municipal waste is processed. However, only 39.7 per cent of this is converted to renewable sources of energy, data accessed from the ministry of power indicates. Surat ranks second in the category of the cleanest city for the Swachh Survekshan Award 2022. Ahmedabad and Rajkot also top in other categories.

CLEAN ENVIRONMENT, SAFE DRINKING WATER AND SANITATION ARE AMONG GUJARAT'S SIX STATED AIMS

Best Performing and Most Improved Small State: Delhi

The system of cleaning the capital of Delhi is as complex as its administrative system. The NDMC looks after the work of cleaning the entire Lutyens Zone and Connaught Place, while the rest of the city is handed over to the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD).

BEST PERFORMING BIG STATES CLEANLINESS

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 70	RANK 2021
1	GUJARAT	53.6	2
2	PUNJAB	53.5	1
3	TAMIL NADU	50.1	7
4	KERALA	49.1	3
5	HIMACHAL PRADESH	48.6	5
6	HARYANA	45.0	11
7	TELANGANA	44.3	4
8	KARNATAKA	43.9	6
9	ANDHRA PRADESH	41.7	8
10	UTTAR PRADESH	39.8	9
11	MAHARASHTRA	39.0	10
12	WEST BENGAL	38.6	14
13	UTTARAKHAND	36.7	16
14	RAJASTHAN	33.8	12
15	CHHATTISGARH	32.5	17
16	MADHYA PRADESH	32.0	13
17	BIHAR	23.5	15
18	ODISHA	20.3	19
19	ASSAM	18.3	20
20	JHARKHAND	17.9	18

BEST PERFORMING SMALL STATES CLEANLINESS

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 70	RANK 2021
1	DELHI	54.9	4
2	GOA	48.8	1
3	PUDUCHERRY	40.7	3
4	SIKKIM	40.6	2
5	MIZORAM	38.4	5
6	NAGALAND	28.2	6
7	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	28.0	7
8	TRIPURA	20.9	8
9	MANIPUR	16.6	9
10	MEGHALAYA	13.8	10

Parameters: % of households with improved sanitation facility, % of schools with separate toilet facility for girls, % of households using improved source of drinking water, % of households using clean fuel